

TOPIC 5: DEPARTMENTS IN AN OFFICE / ORGANISATION

1. Meaning of Departments

A department is a section or unit within an organisation that is responsible for a specific type of work. Large organisations divide work into departments so that tasks are done efficiently by specialists.

2. Common Departments and Their Functions

- a) Administration / General Office** – overall coordination, correspondence, records, reception.
- b) Personnel / Human Resources (HR)** – recruitment, training, staff welfare, salaries and discipline.
- c) Accounts / Finance** – keeping financial records, payments, receipts, budgeting, preparing accounts.
- d) Sales / Marketing** – selling products, advertising, customer relations, market research.
- e) Purchasing / Procurement** – buying goods and materials needed by the organisation.
- f) Production / Operations** – making goods or delivering the main service of the organisation.
- g) Stores / Warehouse** – storing materials and finished goods, stock control.
- h) Transport / Logistics** – movement of goods and staff.
- i) ICT / IT Department** – managing computers, networks and software.

3. Importance of Departments

- Specialisation improves efficiency and quality.
- Clear responsibility and accountability.
- Easier supervision and coordination.
- Helps the organisation achieve its goals systematically.

4. Summary

Organisations are divided into departments such as Administration, HR, Accounts, Sales, Purchasing and Production. Each department has specific functions that together keep the organisation running effectively.

End of Topic 5